with erotic incidents from his recent past. They fascinated us but they might, of course, have been"exaggerated.

Then, on the evening of October 12, we had dinner with Joe Gold-berger and Lee, along with two friends of theirs (Goldberger had taken to calling himself Gould). It was very pleasant and the food was good though I commented on the high prices with some indignation in my diary. Veal cutlets for Gertrude and myself set us back $1.50 apiece.

On October 19, Gertrude and I visited Fred Pohl and his second wife at their apartment in Greenwich Village. I tasted caviar for the first time on that occasion. While there, a fellow Futurian, Dirk Wylie, and his wife, Roz, showed up. Wylie was not well and he died a few years later. Robert Lowndes, who had put on considerable weight, also dropped by. We weren't kids anymore, any of us.

And there was a science-fiction convention.

I hadn't attended any conventions since that first one in New York in 1939. It had set a fashion. Every year over the Labor Day weekend, a "world science-fiction convention" was held. The war years of 1942, 1943, and 1944 were skipped, but except for those, no year has been missed.

The convention is held in a different city every year, and frequently the cities are much too far away for me to get to, considering that I hate to travel. I had attended none of the world conventions since the first.

There were, however, also local conventions held in various cities each year. The oldest of these is the "Philcon," a convention held by fans in the Philadelphia area—and always in Philadelphia, of course.

Although Bob Heinlein and I had left Philadelphia after the war and returned to our native haunts, Sprague de Camp did not. He remained in the Philadelphia area and naturally became an important cog in Philadelphia science-fiction circles and in their convention activities.

Sprague invited me to the 1946 Philcon and, on October 27,1 went

down to Philadelphia. The difference between postwar and prewar was quite marked. My iobot stories and the Foundation series had made me a science-fiction celebrity of the first rank, so that I signed endless autographs and was interviewed by a newspaper reporter for the first time.